Week 3: Concept Exploration Note

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Project: ShopHive, a multi-vendor marketplace app

Screen explored: Home screen

Board link: https://www.figma.com/design/UwaeIAxZWKL9vcxBfsEGLA/FLEXISAF?node-id=2120-737&t=usUA7UjemerPZRwy-1

Tool used

I used Claude (an AI assistant) connected to Figma, to generate the three concept directions from a text prompt.

The brief

I asked for three clearly different design directions for the same Home screen, with the same content in each (search, categories, products) but a different strategy and visual style, so that the comparison is about design decisions and not just colors.

ShopHive Home Screen; The three directions

Concept	Direction	Strengths	Weaknesses
A: Clean Utility	Light, search-first, dense with useful information (prices, ratings, flash-sale timer)	Buyers can search and compare straight away; builds trust with visible prices and delivery location	Less emotional and more familiar; could look like other marketplaces
B: Immersive Dark	Dark theme, large hero banner, collection cards, floating navigation	Premium, memorable look; strong visual storytelling	Product details are hidden behind big visuals; slower for price comparison
C: Community Local	Warm cream and orange, top sellers near you, chat-to-buy button, distance on listings	Friendly and social; builds seller trust and a local feel	One large listing at a time makes comparing products slow; puts sellers ahead of products

My pick: Concept A, Clean Utility

Concept A is the strongest direction for ShopHive. It lets a shopper search, see prices and start browsing within seconds.

What made it stronger than the other two

- **Fast start.** Search and delivery location are the first things a buyer sees, so they can begin finding products straight away.
- **Trust through information.** Prices, ratings and a flash-sale timer show on the first screen. This builds trust and speeds up decisions, which matters in a marketplace where buyers are comparing many sellers.
- **Versus Concept B.** B looks premium, but large visuals hide product details, and a dark theme suits browsing more than buying.
- **Versus Concept C.** C builds community, but showing one large listing at a time makes comparing products slow and puts sellers ahead of products.

What I would borrow from the others

The final design can keep Concept A as its base and take two ideas from the others: the bold hero banner from Concept B for seasonal campaigns, and the verified-seller badge and distance label from Concept C to build seller trust.

What I learned

Giving the AI the same content with three different strategies made the differences easy to judge. The directions were not just three color schemes: each one prioritized something different (speed, emotion, community). Choosing between them was my job, and I based that choice on what a first-time buyer needs most from the Home screen.